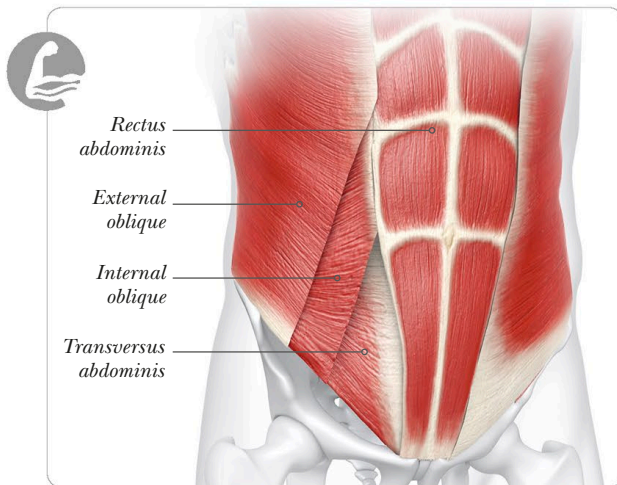


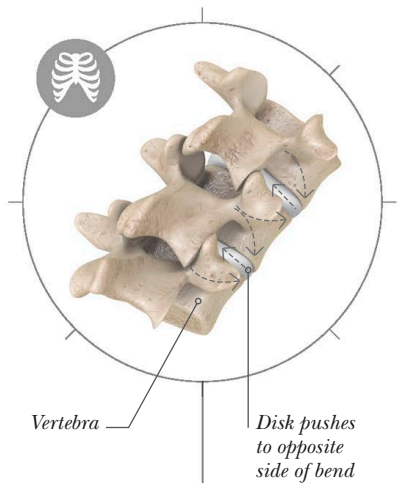
» CLOSER LOOK

Seated side bend is a one-sided movement that dynamically affects your abdominals, back muscles, and spinal disks. You don't have to be able to reach your foot with either hand to do this pose; your arms can simply reach to the side.



Disk health

When side-bending (lateral flexion of the spine), your intervertebral disks push to the sides. As you bend to the right, your disks shift to the left (and vice versa). The cartilage in your spine allows for this natural process.



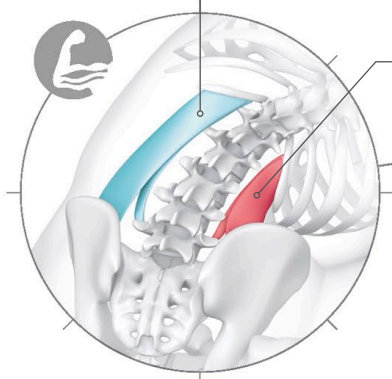
Abdominal structure

Your criss-crossing abdominal muscles provide multilayered support for your internal organs and allow your torso to move. Legend has it that in 1888, Dr. Dunlop, a surgeon, was watching his son bouncing on his tricycle due to the poor design of the wheels, causing a headache. Inspired by the structure of the abdominals, he designed a tire for a smoother ride and fewer flats.

Quadratus lumborum stretches on upper side

Quadratus lumborum engages on lower side

Latissimus dorsi stretches on the upper side



Unilateral movement

Your quadratus lumborum (QL) is important for holding posture. When the erector spinae are weak it picks up the slack. Keeping your spine erect is a big job for this little muscle, leading to muscle fatigue and even pain. This pose helps by stretching and engaging the QL.

